Food Safety and Allergen Standard

Version 4. Effective June 1, 2026. Owner: Quality and Food Safety Manager. Approved by the Leadership Team on May 11, 2026. Replaces version 3.

1 Scope

This standard applies to every café and to the roastery's tasting room. It covers how milk, food, and prepared drink ingredients are stored and held, temperature checks, allergens, handwashing, and when a sick employee stays home. Where the local health code is stricter, follow the health code.

2 Holding temperatures and times

Cold items are held at 41°F (5°C) or below, and hot items at 135°F (57°C) or above. Label every opened or prepared item with the date and time it was opened or made, and throw it out when its time runs out.

Item	Hold at	Discard
Dairy milk and cream, opened	41°F (5°C) or below	4 days after opening, or the printed date if sooner
Oat, almond, and soy milk, opened	41°F (5°C) or below	7 days after opening, or the printed date if sooner
Milk left in a steaming pitcher	Not held	After each drink; never re-steam
Cold brew concentrate	41°F (5°C) or below	7 days after the steep ends
Brewed iced tea	41°F (5°C) or below	24 hours after brewing
House-made whipped cream	41°F (5°C) or below	48 hours after making
House-made syrups	41°F (5°C) or below	14 days after making
Cut fruit and yogurt cups	41°F (5°C) or below	48 hours after prep
Breakfast sandwiches in the warmer	135°F (57°C) or above	4 hours after reaching temperature
Pastries in the case	Room temperature	At close: donate or log as waste

3 Heating sandwiches

Heat breakfast sandwiches in the oven to an internal temperature of 165°F (74°C), checked with a probe thermometer, before they go in the warmer. Record one probe reading per batch on the temperature log. A sandwich that drops below 135°F (57°C) in the warmer is thrown out, not reheated.

4 Fridge and freezer checks

Read every fridge and freezer thermometer at opening, at 2:00 p.m., and at close, and record the readings on the temperature log. Freezers read 0°F (-18°C) or below. If a fridge reads above 41°F (5°C), check it again after 30 minutes. If it's still above 41°F (5°C), move everything to another fridge, call the Facilities help desk, and tell the Café Manager. Throw out any milk or food that has been above 41°F (5°C) for more than 4 hours, or for an unknown length of time.

5 Allergens

5.1 What we track

Halcyon tracks the nine major allergens: milk, eggs, fish, shellfish, tree nuts, peanuts, wheat, soy, and sesame. Almond milk and the hazelnut and pistachio syrups contain tree nuts. Oat milk is not certified gluten-free. Each pastry's allergens are printed on its label and listed in the allergen binder.

5.2 Making an allergy order

When a guest mentions an allergy, add the ALLERGY modifier in the register so it prints on the cup label. The barista making the drink washes their hands, takes a pitcher from the clean rack, purges and wipes the steam wand before steaming, and uses the purple allergen-safe blender jar for blended drinks. Tell the guest that our cafés handle all nine allergens and we can't promise any item is free of them.

5.3 If a guest has a reaction

Call 911 if the guest has trouble breathing, swelling of the face or throat, or feels faint. Don't give the guest any medication, though they may use their own epinephrine injector. Tell the Café Manager, keep the cup and any packaging, and file an incident report in the safety portal within 24 hours.

6 Handwashing and gloves

Wash your hands for at least 20 seconds at the start of each shift, after breaks, after handling raw eggs, cash, or trash, and before putting on gloves. Wear gloves to handle ready-to-eat food that won't be cooked. Change gloves every 4 hours, and whenever they tear or you change tasks.

7 Illness

An employee with vomiting, diarrhea, or jaundice doesn't work until 48 hours after the symptoms stop. An employee with a sore throat and a fever works only away from food and drinks, such as on the register, until the fever is gone. Tell the person in charge before the shift; paid sick time covers the missed shifts.